Task-5

UPI fraud is a common type of cybercrime where people lose money through online payment apps like Google Pay or PhonePe. Nowadays many people use UPI, so fraud cases are also increasing. In this type of fraud, scammers try to trick people into sending money or sharing important details.

Usually, it starts with a phone call or message from an unknown number. The person pretends to be from a bank or says there is some problem with your account. They create panic so that the person reacts quickly. Then they ask for OTP, UPI PIN, or send a link and tell the person to click on it. Once the victim shares the details, the fraudster transfers money from their account.

These scams mostly target normal users, students, and elderly people who are not fully aware of online safety. Even educated people sometimes fall for it because the messages look real.

The result of this fraud can be serious, like losing money and feeling stressed. It also makes people scared to use online payment apps again.

This case shows that we should never share OTP or UPI PIN with anyone and always check before trusting any unknown message or call.

Stay Safe Online – Checklist for College Students (India)

- Use strong, unique passwords for each account (avoid using your name, DOB, or “123456”).
- Enable **two-factor authentication (2FA)** on email, banking, and social media accounts.
- Do not click on suspicious links in emails, WhatsApp, or SMS—even if they look official.
- Never share personal details (OTP, passwords, Aadhaar, bank info) with anyone online.
- Avoid using public Wi-Fi for banking, shopping, or logging into sensitive accounts.
- Install apps only from trusted sources like Google Play Store or Apple App Store.

UPI / Financial Safety Tips

- Never approve unknown UPI collect requests (Pay requests). Scammers often trick users into “receiving” money.
- Do not share your **UPI PIN** with anyone—no bank or app will ever ask for it.
- Always verify the receiver’s name before sending money via UPI.
- Beware of fake customer care numbers found on Google—always use official websites.

If You Become a Victim

- Report immediately on: **National Cyber Crime Portal – https://cybercrime.gov.in**
- Call the **Cyber Crime Helpline: 1930** (for financial fraud emergencies)